Wall Street Journal described, Ratan ‘led a drive to expand internationally, a strategy India’s other sprawling companies seek to emulate’. Even the soft-spoken, underplaying Ratan could not contain his excitement at having raided the redoubts of Western capitalism when he succeeded in his effort. During a speech he gave at a felicitation function at Cornell, Ratan said of his acquisitions that they were ‘a bit of the empire striking back’.